MULTIMEDIA 12 · DESIGN A STORY · DRAFT CLIENT COMMISSION

A real design problem. Your own visual story.

Choose a fictional client or propose an equivalent commission. Learn the tools, make independent choices, test the message and defend the result.

16 illustrated stages | Creative choice | Planning + documented production | Observation · conversation · product



Parallel seed-library practice source. Synthetic photo; not an assessed client design.

Start here

> Draft for review. Native Photoshop action capture/save/reopen, independent cold run, approved rubric/OS and school-device gates remain open.

Four client briefs + usable assets · Planning/documentation journal · Rubric views · Evidence/defence lesson

Use the existing design teaching decks first if the diagnostic shows the principles are new. Knowledge/reflection goes through the existing Design a Story Form.

Printable route · Complete offline kit

Professional connection

Study the genuine IKEA historical catalogue and current professional identities in the existing teaching gallery. Observe hierarchy, colour, type and context before deciding which relationship can inform your own work. Analyse-only references are not production assets.

Knowledge before controls

A mood board argues for direction; a thumbnail explores an idea; an artboard develops a defined layout. A mask changes visibility; an adjustment changes image relationships. Hierarchy, value/colour and type must help the audience understand this brief.

What this assesses

MM12 image-manipulation outcomes 1.1–1.5: purposeful manipulation, image context, recoverable procedures, design principles and communication. Teacher O/C/P evidence is judged through the same criteria. Knowledge/reflection supports correction. This still-image project does not certify motion, sound or the whole course.

SESSION 1 · LESSONS 1

Brief, research and concepts

Suggested 70-minute block; adjust the existing allocation after the diagnostic.

01 Read the client problem

Start here: read or listen to the theory deck (about 10 minutes, with checkpoint questions), then come back.

DOCUMENT: Client brief + journal
SELECT: One selected client
TOOLS / ROUTE: Client studio → client brief → journal

1. Read the backstory, audience and approved factual copy. Identify what the older communication got wrong.
2. Choose a client or propose an equivalent one. Record the actual problem, viewing encounter and one observable communication goal in the journal.
3. Name which facts must remain and which visual decisions are yours. Agree feasible checkpoints with the teacher.

Record the consequential evidence in your saved journal



OpenAI image generation, art-directed for Chad · Original AI-assisted classroom production asset. Raw production source; not a software capture. Full credit/licence.

WHY

A design decision has a purpose when it changes what this audience can understand.

CHECK

A peer can restate your intended message and constraints.

FIX

If the goal says only “make it look good”, name the first message and what the viewer needs next.

02 Study genuine references

DOCUMENT: Reference analysis record
SELECT: Two genuine historical/current references
TOOLS / ROUTE: Sources → primary campaign/catalogue pages

1. Open the IKEA Museum historical catalogue and a contemporary professional identity from the existing teaching gallery.
2. Record maker/date/medium/source. Separate one visible observation, one sourced contextual fact and one interpretation for each.
3. Explain a useful design relationship and the limit of comparing different media. Keep references for study separate from production rights.

Record the consequential evidence in your saved journal



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WHY

Context affects image meaning; preference alone does not establish an audience effect.

CHECK

Both references have traceable sources and distinct fact/inference statements.

FIX

If you cannot verify a contextual claim, label it as a hypothesis or replace it with a sourced fact.

03 Build a direction board

DOCUMENT: Editable mood board + PNG
SELECT: A small meaningful set of references
TOOLS / ROUTE: Excalidraw.com → image/text tools → editable scene/export

1. Open Excalidraw in the browser. Insert the chosen local image using its image tool or drag the file onto the canvas; place a few credited references for study.
2. Use the text tool to label each source and its purpose. Add proposed palette-role labels and title/detail type candidates. Keep the board readable.
3. Open the main menu and save the editable .excalidraw scene. Export a PNG viewing copy. Reopen the scene and change one label to check editability. If blocked, use paper plus a clear photograph and the same credits.

Record the consequential evidence in your saved journal



Filippo Diotalevi from London, United KIngdom · CC BY 2.0. Raw production source; not a software capture. Full credit/licence.

WHY

A mood board argues for a direction; it is different from a layout.

CHECK

Each selected ingredient has a reason and the editable/viewing files reopen.

FIX

Remove attractive items whose purpose you cannot explain. Do not confuse an analyse-only ad with a production asset.

04 Compare three concepts

DOCUMENT: Thumbnail sheet + journal
SELECT: Three distinct communication devices or arrangements
TOOLS / ROUTE: Paper, Excalidraw or existing drawing tools

1. Draw three small thumbnails with the same approved information. Change the dominant arrangement or communication device.
2. Name what each makes visible first and one likely advantage/problem for this viewer. No finished effects are needed.
3. Choose a direction using the brief and feasible controls. Retain a rejected concept and reason.

Record the consequential evidence in your saved journal



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WHY

Alternatives reveal decisions. Three recolourings of one layout test treatments, not concepts.

CHECK

A viewer can distinguish three concepts before colour or detail.

FIX

If ideas look identical, change how the message is carried: scene, object relationship, image/type relationship or another defensible approach.

SESSION 2 · LESSONS 2

Treatments and production foundations

Suggested 70-minute block; adjust the existing allocation after the diagnostic.

05 Test colour and type treatments

Recall first (from last lesson, no peeking):

1. How does a concept differ from a treatment?
2. What turns a reference into usable evidence?
3. What must the client invitation communicate first?

Say or write your answers, then check them against your file.

DOCUMENT: Two treatment views
SELECT: One selected concept
TOOLS / ROUTE: Existing Design Lab → colour/typography studios

1. Predict one useful colour/value or type-spacing change for your concept. Keep the compared arrangement and message similar.
2. Use a focused Design Lab study to compare the change. Name the wheel model when using complementary/analogous language; inspect actual text/background values.
3. Export the study and record the selected treatment, visible evidence and a trade-off. Your palette/type may differ from the client starting suggestions.

Record the consequential evidence in your saved journal

WHY

Relationships must serve readable meaning rather than random control use.

CHECK

The two views differ in the intended variable and the reason refers to visible evidence.

FIX

If many variables changed, isolate one and compare again before defending a result.

SIMULATION · Design Lab

Predict one purposeful change, compare its visible effect and export the study. **Open Design Lab ↗**

Back in your log: Carry one justified relationship into your own design. Works offline; nothing you do in it is collected.

06 Build and keep a swatch set

DOCUMENT: Practice PSD + client palette files
SELECT: Client ACO or one foreground colour
TOOLS / ROUTE: Window → Swatches → panel menu → Import Swatches; manual colour picker route

1. In the separate practice document, open Window → Swatches. From the panel menu choose Import Swatches; select this client's palette.aco. Retain existing collections.
2. Check each imported colour against palette.json. If import is unavailable, click the foreground-colour chip, enter the six-digit HEX value, confirm, then create a new named swatch from the Swatches panel. Repeat by role.
3. Apply two colours to a practice title/background pair, compare readability, save the practice PSD and record the roles. ASE is an alternative exchange file; its native import must also be checked.

Native procedure not yet run. Photoshop 2026 action captures and saved/reopened demonstration are pending an exclusive native run. Use only with a teacher demonstration until verified.

Record the consequential evidence in your saved journal

WHY

A reusable palette gives consistent values; colour relationships still require judgment.

CHECK

Five values match the client record and can be selected again.

FIX

Do not replace or delete existing swatches. If no exact entry/import route is visible, ask for the current version demonstration rather than guessing.

07 Create the print study

DOCUMENT: New print study
SELECT: New document settings
TOOLS / ROUTE: File → New → custom document → Create

1. Choose File → New. Set units Pixels, width 2550, height 3300, resolution 300 pixels/inch, RGB colour, 8 bit. Choose a white background and create.
2. Check Image → Image Size without resampling to confirm pixel dimensions. This is a school RGB print study, not a verified press profile.
3. Save as a new layered PSD in the project folder. Use a project code and stage name; preserve supplied source files.

Native procedure not yet run. Photoshop 2026 action captures and saved/reopened demonstration are pending an exclusive native run. Use only with a teacher demonstration until verified.

Record the consequential evidence in your saved journal

WHY

Dimensions describe the delivery encounter; a verified printer profile is a separate requirement.

CHECK

The document reports 2550 × 3300 pixels and a layered PSD is saved.

FIX

If dimensions use inches unexpectedly, select Pixels and recheck. Do not resize an existing source destructively to hide a wrong document.

08 Practise a recoverable mask

DOCUMENT: Seed-library practice PSD
SELECT: The placed image layer, then its mask thumbnail
TOOLS / ROUTE: File → Place Embedded; Select → Subject; Layer mask; Brush

1. Open the separate seed-library practice source in a practice PSD. Use File → Place Embedded for a permitted secondary source, confirm placement and rename its layer.
2. Select the secondary image layer. Use Select → Subject, inspect the selection, then add a layer mask. Inspect the actual edge at 100% and at the intended viewing size.
3. Click the mask thumbnail before Brush. Set a soft round brush, Opacity 100%, Flow 100%; choose a brush size suited to the edge. Black hides and white reveals. Make a small reversible change, then undo/redo to inspect it.

Native procedure not yet run. Photoshop 2026 action captures and saved/reopened demonstration are pending an exclusive native run. Use only with a teacher demonstration until verified.

Record the consequential evidence in your saved journal

WHY

The mask changes visibility without erasing the original pixels. This is a practice technique, not a required client composition.

CHECK

The correct mask is selected and the original image can be revealed again.

FIX

If pixels are being painted, undo and select the mask thumbnail. If Select Subject is unsuitable, ask for a taught manual selection method; do not assume the automatic result is correct.

SESSION 3 · LESSONS 3

Craft and delivery checks

Suggested 70-minute block; adjust the existing allocation after the diagnostic.

09 Practise a purposeful adjustment

Recall first (from last lesson, no peeking):

1. What does a layer mask change?
2. How would you isolate an adjustment?
3. How do tracking and kerning differ?

Say or write your answers, then check them against your file.

DOCUMENT: Practice composite PSD
SELECT: Base image, then adjustment layer/mask
TOOLS / ROUTE: Layer → New Adjustment Layer → Curves; optional Create Clipping Mask

1. Identify one actual tonal mismatch in the separate practice file. Add a Curves adjustment above the relevant image through Layer → New Adjustment Layer → Curves.
2. Predict the tonal change before editing. Make one small curve change and toggle the adjustment to compare at the same view. Exact curve values depend on the source; do not copy an unrelated recipe.
3. If the change should affect only the intended base image, select the adjustment and use Layer → Create Clipping Mask. Refine the adjustment's mask where needed. Save a version and record the control/result.

Native procedure not yet run. Photoshop 2026 action captures and saved/reopened demonstration are pending an exclusive native run. Use only with a teacher demonstration until verified.

Record the consequential evidence in your saved journal

WHY

A controlled comparison makes the change explainable and revisable.

CHECK

Toggling isolates the intended effect and unrelated areas are retained.

FIX

If everything changes unexpectedly, inspect clipping/base relationship and adjustment mask before adding more effects.

10 Keep type editable

DOCUMENT: Practice title/detail layers
SELECT: Type layer and selected text or insertion point
TOOLS / ROUTE: Type tool → Window → Character / Paragraph

1. Create title and detail text with the Type tool. Use available school fonts; record any substitution rather than installing fonts.
2. Open Window → Character and Paragraph. On selected title text compare tracking 0 and 30 as a practice-only range. For a particular pair, place the insertion point between the letters before testing kerning. Leading changes baseline separation.
3. Choose a readable hierarchy for the intended view, align related details and preserve Type layers. Do not rasterise text merely to move or resize it.

Native procedure not yet run. Photoshop 2026 action captures and saved/reopened demonstration are pending an exclusive native run. Use only with a teacher demonstration until verified.

Record the consequential evidence in your saved journal

WHY

Typography relationships guide reading; a practice value is not a mandated design answer.

CHECK

Text remains editable and the student can identify pair/range/baseline controls.

FIX

If the wrong text changes, check the layer and selection. If a pair setting affects the whole line, inspect whether a range rather than an insertion point is selected.

11 Adapt a second view

DOCUMENT: Screen PSD or screen artboard
SELECT: Artboard group/tool or a separate new document
TOOLS / ROUTE: Move tool group → Artboard tool; Properties dimensions; or File → New

1. Optional artboard route: select the Artboard tool from the Move tool group. Create/select a screen artboard; set width 1080 and height 1350 pixels in Properties and name it Screen. Verify the print artboard separately.
2. If artboards are unavailable or slow to learn, create a separate 1080 × 1350 RGB document through File → New. Bring in permitted sources and editable text; retain layers.
3. Reflow the chosen concept for the new encounter. Retain essential client facts; move/reprioritise rather than stretch the entire print image. Save the editable screen source.

Native procedure not yet run. Photoshop 2026 action captures and saved/reopened demonstration are pending an exclusive native run. Use only with a teacher demonstration until verified.

Record the consequential evidence in your saved journal

WHY

Different encounters can require different arrangements even when the idea stays the same.

CHECK

Both dimensions are correct, sources editable and the message survives the smaller view.

FIX

If the subject is distorted, undo whole-image stretching. Select the relevant item/group and adapt the arrangement.

12 Save and reopen the sources

DOCUMENT: Print + screen PSDs and PNGs
SELECT: Each relevant document/artboard
TOOLS / ROUTE: File → Save As / Save a Copy; File → Export → Export As

1. Save each layered PSD. Use File → Export → Export As for a viewing PNG; confirm the intended pixel dimensions and sRGB viewing colour.
2. Close only the saved practice/project copy and reopen its PSD. Check a source, editable Type layer, meaningful mask and adjustment. Do not close other unsaved documents.
3. Open each PNG separately, inspect the intended full view and 100% detail, then compare it with the PSD. Record filename, dimensions and any mismatch.

Native procedure not yet run. Photoshop 2026 action captures and saved/reopened demonstration are pending an exclusive native run. Use only with a teacher demonstration until verified.

Record the consequential evidence in your saved journal

WHY

A handoff must survive reopening, not simply a successful save click.

CHECK

PSD controls and exported dimensions remain correct after reopening.

FIX

If reopening shows a flat image, locate the PSD rather than PNG. If an export has wrong content/dimensions, check the selected artboard and export options.

SESSION 4 · LESSONS 4

Test, adapt and defend

Suggested 70-minute block; adjust the existing allocation after the diagnostic.

13 Test actual communication

Recall first (from last lesson, no peeking):

1. What must survive a PSD reopen?
2. How does a phone version differ from a scaled print image?
3. Why are two viewers not an audience survey?

Say or write your answers, then check them against your file.

DOCUMENT: Anonymous viewer-test record
SELECT: First export at intended view
TOOLS / ROUTE: Show → neutral questions → journal

1. Before explaining your design, show it at the intended view to two viewers. Ask what they noticed first and what they think is being offered.
2. Record their actual responses without peer names. Compare each with your intended reading and practical next action.
3. Identify one meaningful mismatch and a predicted repair. Keep disagreement and state the limit of a two-person diagnostic.

Record the consequential evidence in your saved journal

WHY

Actual response reveals a communication problem that a self-description may miss.

CHECK

The record distinguishes what viewers said from your interpretation.

FIX

If your question tells them the answer, repeat with a neutral prompt on the next version.

14 Revise one relationship

DOCUMENT: Versioned source + before/after
SELECT: The control relevant to the observed mismatch
TOOLS / ROUTE: Predict → one change → inspect → retest

1. Keep a before view. Choose one relevant control or arrangement change based on the mismatch and state the predicted effect.
2. Change the selected relationship recoverably, save a new version and compare at the same intended view.
3. Retest the revised message, record the result and one trade-off/remaining limitation. Use actual feedback, not invented improvement claims.

Record the consequential evidence in your saved journal



Alina Zienowicz (Ala z), e-mail · CC BY-SA 3.0. Raw production source; not a software capture. Full credit/licence.

WHY

Revision shows how evidence changes a decision.

CHECK

Before/after and the recorded test trace a purposeful change.

FIX

If the change cannot be linked to the mismatch, return to the original problem rather than adding effects.

15 Respond to a client change

DOCUMENT: New version + brief defence
SELECT: Teacher-assigned change card
TOOLS / ROUTE: Independent choose → adapt → check → defend

1. After taught practice, receive a client-change card from the teacher. Restate the new constraint and predict a response using taught methods.
2. Choose and make an appropriate change without a supplied composition. Preserve the prior version and inspect the result.
3. Point to source evidence and explain the effect, a rejected option and a limit. Access supports remain available; any procedural assistance is recorded separately.

Record the consequential evidence in your saved journal



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WHY

Changed conditions reveal transfer beyond reproducing a tutorial.

CHECK

The student chooses a relevant strategy and can locate the actual evidence.

FIX

If the requested effect was never taught, ask for an equivalent taught change; do not guess an unseen advanced procedure.

16 Deliver and revisit

DOCUMENT: Restricted school Drive folder + Form record
SELECT: Checked source/export/planning/decision files
TOOLS / ROUTE: School Google Drive → restricted teacher share → existing Form

1. Assemble print/screen PSDs and PNGs, mood-board source/view, thumbnails/treatments and the downloaded journal/source record. Check each file opens.
2. Share the restricted school Drive folder with cwadden@gnspes.ca. Submit its link and concise decision evidence through the existing Final reflection and evidence handoff Form. For planning use Proposal and planning.
3. Keep the Form confirmation and local backup. When teacher feedback is released, record criterion/next action and a fresh revisit linked to the original attempt.

Record the consequential evidence in your saved journal

WHY

Evidence is usable only when the teacher can locate it and the learner can act on feedback.

CHECK

Files, rights, recipient permissions and Form confirmation are explicitly checked.

FIX

A local Saved status is not submission. If teacher access fails, correct the restricted share and retain the work while the route is checked.

BEFORE YOU SUBMIT

Student QA.

- [ ] Client facts are retained; my creative concept is mine.
- [ ] Three concepts and two treatments support a selected direction.
- [ ] Sources/AI use are credited and production rights clear.
- [ ] Both editable PSDs and viewing PNGs reopen with correct dimensions.
- [ ] A meaningful mask/adjustment and editable type can be demonstrated.
- [ ] Actual viewer responses and before/after revision are retained.
- [ ] Restricted teacher folder access and registered Form confirmation are checked.

Ask for help with a decision

Copy the context, add your current problem and attempted change, then open the shared Coach. Ask for a hint or explanation; keep your assessed concept and final decisions yours.

Open Learning Studio Coach

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MM12 · mm12-design-story-v1 · Design a Story client commission
I am developing my own client concept. Current stage: __. Client/audience/intent: __.
My selected layer/control: __. I expected __; I observed __. I tried __.
Explain the relevant principle or give one hint. Do not supply my assessed final composition.
Help me record intent → choice/control → visible evidence → reason.
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Open existing Student OS when your school account is enabled. Required submission is the registered project Form and restricted source folder; a local journal or Coach conversation is not a submitted evidence event.

SOURCES AND AUTHORSHIP

Method references.

Image credits Creators, exact source links, licences and AI provenance for every supplied/displayed image sources.html

Curriculum Nova Scotia Multimedia 12 outcomes, Module 1; checked 10 October 2026
https://curriculum.novascotia.ca/sites/default/files/documents/outcomes-indicators-files/Multimedia%2012%20Outcomes%20(2015).pdf

IKEA IKEA Museum historical catalogue study https://ikeamuseum.com/en/explore/ikea-catalogue/1951-ikea-catalogue/

LDF Pentagram London Design Festival 2025, contemporary identity study https://www.pentagram.com/work/london-design-festival-2025

Adobe Adobe artboards and native software guidance; documentation differs from a local run
https://helpx.adobe.com/photoshop/desktop/create-manage-layers/layout-design-tools/create-artboard-documents.html

Photo credits

Figures marked Illustration are drawn, not screenshots. Step values are starting points authored for this project. Draft for teacher review; not yet classroom-piloted.

Draft for review. Native Photoshop procedures 6–12 have not yet been run/captured in this new package; no synthetic software UI or fabricated mistake pair is provided. Independent cold run and current intended-account/OS checks remain pending. Browser read-aloud is a disclosed device fallback; no teacher recording is supplied.